



» The Budget displays a clear intent of moving towards an era of enhanced capex and asset creation, and reducing the over-reliance on revenue expenditure and subsidies

» At a time when the private sector has been shying away from investing in the infrastructure sector, a higher government allocation of ₹10

lakh crore for the infrastructure sector will help provide a fillip to projects across a diverse spectrum

» India will need to do things differently to ensure that investments in manufacturing complement other sectors of the economy



THE LONG AND SHORT OF TAXATION

Nitin Gupta,
Chairman, Central Board of Direct Taxes

» The new tax regime is expected to be a game changer

» The number of tax slabs have been reduced and the surcharge for the rich and super-rich has been moderated. So, a lot has changed despite there being no deductions or exemptions

» You can file the returns

of income in a very simple manner, without the help of a professional

» Certain people are taking advantage of the trust that the government has reposed in them by claiming wrongful deductions and exemptions. The changes proposed in the Budget are expected to make these a thing of the past

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» Capital expenditure is the secret sauce for growth as it yields long-term growth, apart from creating a massive number of jobs

» Investments in infrastructure, such as railways, airports, highways and metro lines have a multiplier

effect on the economy

» The government is creating assets that are going to turn us more productive and more efficient over the next 30 to 50 years

» Investments in infrastructure

THE PRIORITIES OF A BUDGET BEFORE AN ELECTION

Siddharth Zarabi (left), Managing Editor, *Business Today* TV, with

Jayant Sinha,
BJP MP, Lok Sabha

projects yield benefits to the economy to the tune of 2.5 times; it's even higher for airports at six times

» By keeping inflation and interest rates under control, the government has provided the right environment for private capex growth